

languages. Huge community support and built-in modules make it very popular.

Popular frameworks. Catalyst, Dancer and Mojolicious are some of the frameworks that use Perl.

Syntax. Shown below is the basic syntax for Perl:

```
#!/usr/bin/perl
$abc = 10;
print "Value of abc = $abc\n";
print "program is over";
```

The extension for Perl files is *.pl* or *.pm*, which is based on a file or module.

PHP

PHP is also a general-purpose language but it is mainly used for Web development. It's a server-side scripting language designed by Rasmus Lerdorf. It is very popular for small- or medium-level website development compared to other languages. It is also used by some giant firms like Facebook, YouTube and Yahoo! Nowadays, there are a lot of frameworks built on PHP which compete with Python and Perl. Though demand for Python is increasing, PHP is still very popular in both small and large organisations. The current version of PHP is 7.1.2.

Advantages.

- Most people prefer PHP when it comes to creating dynamic Web pages, because it's easier to set up in local host and most of the hosting providers offer built-in PHP support.
- It's easy to use. The syntax is mostly the same as that of C language. Anyone can easily adopt it.
- There are lots of frameworks available for PHP and it has immense community support.
- PHP is stable. Since it's used by many developers, code maintenance is very quick.
- PHP has strong database support and provides native session management.
- PHP 7 is much faster than any other version of PHP.

Disadvantages.

- Some of the libraries written in PHP are procedural, so it's difficult for programmers from an object-oriented background.
- Since it is open source, security is a major challenge. As the code is available to all, intruders can easily find weaknesses in the code.
- It becomes slow after a certain scale. Therefore large-scale organisations use their own customised frameworks to increase performance.
- PHP is not suitable for desktop applications. Besides, its error handling capabilities are poor.

Popularity. PHP is still very popular and one of the top-10 languages used by Web developers to create dynamic websites. Web developers should definitely learn PHP to kickstart their careers.

Popular frameworks. Laravel, Symfony, CodeIgniter and Phalcon are some of the popular frameworks.

Syntax. PHP scripting code is written using the `<?php` start tag and `?>` end tag:

```
<?php // PHP code ?>
```

The file extension is *.php*, and usually contains PHP scripts and HTML code.

Python

Python is a general-purpose and high-level programming language designed by Guido van Rossum in the late 1980s. It's very elegant and easy to learn. Nowadays, a beginner's first priority is to learn Python. It supports multiple paradigms—functional, imperative, procedural and OO (object oriented). Python is an all-round language. Since it's often a first choice, it can be found everywhere. It can be used in testing, automation, Web development, data analytics, cloud computing, mobile development and game development. Python uses indentation to identify the block, which eliminates the need for curly brackets

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